In 1928, the arrival of Sir John Simon and Clement Attlee in Bombay, together with five other British Members of Parliament, tasked by the British Government to evaluate the administrative implementation of the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919 and map out a constitutional future for India, brought the prospect of a new lease for Hindu-Muslim unity. This hope was quickly frustrated after their arrival. While both the League and the Congress boycotted the Simon Commission for its lack of native Indian representatives, both parties quarrelled over a constructive counter-proposal on framing an Indian constitution.

Jinnah rejected the Congress-backed Nehru Report, a constitutional draft championed, among others, by Motilal Nehru, Jawaharlal's father. Jinnah rejected it for substantive reasons, like its advice to scrap separate electorates and weightage for minorities or vesting residuary powers at the Centre with weaker provinces. However, Jinnah was also incensed by the tone of the report. Motilal ridiculed the legitimate Muslim angst from being dominated by a Hindu majority in a future democracy as a 'baseless fear', the desire for separate electorates as 'clumsy and objectionable', and the demand for reservations as counterproductive to ensuring the security of minorities.[26]

A young Jawaharlal's contribution to the report consisted in the laborious task to extrapolate the potential Muslim vote share by looking at the Census of 1921 in the two big Muslim-majority provinces, the Punjab and Bengal. Agreeing with the overall analysis of his father, Jawaharlal concluded that 'there is no foundation in fact for the fears entertained by the Muslims in these two provinces, and indeed no occasion for any adventitious aid to secure to them the full benefit of their natural majority'.[27] Motilal's secular constitutional assessment found applause within the Hindu Mahasabha, an influential organization that sought to protect Hindu rights and push back against Muslim influence.[28]

Against the Nehru Report, Jinnah proposed his Fourteen Points, which sought, among other things, a federal constitutional
make-up of India with residual power vested in the provinces, a fixed Muslim representation in the Central legislature and the upholding of